

REJO Z MATHEW

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Senior data, analytics, and AI leader with 20+ years in financial services — consumer banking, lending, and deposits — driving customer growth and business performance through analytics, ML, and governed data platforms. Has owned pricing, portfolio economics, and marketing and operational analytics as well as cloud-native data architecture, decisioning frameworks, and responsible AI in regulated environments. Leads global teams and partners with C-suite stakeholders on enterprise data & AI strategy; has led M&A execution across portfolio divestiture and acquisition integration.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Business & Domain: Consumer Banking, Lending & Deposits | Customer Acquisition, Retention & Lifecycle Analytics | Portfolio, Pricing & Credit Analytics | Customer Experience & Decision Intelligence | M&A Integration, Divestiture & Migration

Strategy & Leadership: Enterprise Data & AI Strategy, Architecture & Modernization | Technical Program & Data Product Management | Cross-Functional Stakeholder Partnership | Global Team Leadership & Development

Platform & Technology: Cloud-Native Data Platforms (AWS, GCP, Snowflake, Databricks, Spark) | Knowledge Graph, Semantic Layer & BI (Neo4j, AtScale, Tableau) | MarTech & CRM Integration (Adobe, Segment, Salesforce)

AI/ML & Governance: AI/GenAI Lifecycle & Responsible AI (ML, LLMs, RAG, Agentic AI, MLOps, Observability) | Data Governance, Quality, Metadata & Lineage (Alation, Anomalo) | Regulatory Compliance (KYC/AML, TCPA, GLBA, PCI DSS, GDPR/CCPA)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sr. Director, Data, Analytics & AI, Discover Financial Services, Chicago

June 2022 – May 2026

- Partnered with BU and marketing analytics teams to build customer **acquisition, servicing, and retention analytics** across personal loans, home loans, and deposits — segmentation, campaign measurement, and KPI reporting for business line leaders.
- Integrated MarTech, CRM, digital, contact center, and core banking data into the enterprise platform, enabling ML-driven personalization and **next-best-action** decisioning that delivered **~\$100M** in measurable business impact.
- Drove Discover's **enterprise data & AI platform transformation**, delivering a modern cloud-native analytics environment (AWS, Snowflake) with improved scalability, interoperability, and model time-to-production.
- Established master data management (MDM) and entity resolution for core customer entities via enterprise **identity knowledge graph** (Neo4j) and Customer 360 platform, unifying customer data for journey analytics, segmentation, and cross-product insight.
- Directed data workstreams for Discover's \$9B student-loan portfolio **migration and divestiture**, partnering with Finance on balance walk validation across 2M+ accounts with 20-year history, collection curves, and vintage analysis supporting portfolio sale.
- Orchestrated customer data consolidation and account reconciliation for Capital One's \$35B acquisition of Discover — integrating customer records across core banking and CRM systems under regulatory timelines to deliver **Day 1 operational readiness**.
- Operationalized **GenAI and ML** use cases — RAG-based document matching, ML classification — with human-in-the-loop (HITL) validation and governed workflows; architected a **multi-agent** workflow for governance metadata curation.
- Built **governance and observability** frameworks for production data and AI systems — data quality, lineage, drift monitoring, and explainability — enabling auditable delivery in a regulated environment.
- Partnered with **C-level** executives as an advisor to shape enterprise data & AI strategy, drive data literacy, and guide adoption of self-service analytics and AI decisioning across business lines.
- Oversaw a global data organization of ~75 (incl. ~50 contractors) — data scientists, analysts, data product managers, and engineers — driving a product-oriented delivery model with backlogs prioritized across Risk, Marketing, Finance, and Compliance.

Director, Data, Analytics & AI, Discover Financial Services, Chicago

Oct 2018 – June 2022

- Appointed under a **mandate from the President of Consumer Banking** to build enterprise data and analytics capabilities — defined a 5+ year strategy and investment-backed roadmap across all Consumer Banking business lines.
- Architected and scaled an **enterprise ML feature store** supporting AI/ML use cases across credit risk, retention, CLV, and customer analytics, enabling consistent, production-ready features for downstream models.
- Delivered **self-service BI capabilities** for all Consumer Banking business lines, significantly accelerating insight delivery and democratizing access to curated data assets.
- Designed an enterprise marketing analytics database anchored on first-party data, enabling privacy-compliant campaign targeting, execution, and measurement across channels in a post-GDPR/CCPA landscape.
- Developed balance history and portfolio analytics data framework for consumer loan products, supporting Finance, Credit Strategy and BU analytics teams with reconciliation, trend analysis, and regulatory reporting.
- Implemented centralized control and exception management (ServiceNow) to support **CFPB consent order remediation** — establishing audit trails, escalation workflows, and closed-loop tracking across compliance functions.
- Served as **Chief Data Steward** for Consumer Banking, advancing governance frameworks, data-quality standards, and control policies to strengthen regulatory compliance and analytic reliability.

Sr. Manager, Analytics, BI & Pricing, Discover Financial Services, Chicago

Jul 2016 – Oct 2018

- Redesigned risk-based pricing models and product structures, improving loan portfolio profitability and driving a **20% increase in ROE** while enhancing conversion performance.
- Stood up the analytical data environment and BI infrastructure from the ground up following an origination system migration, enabling enterprise reporting and marketing analytics for Discover Home Loans.
- Designed and operationalized a **multi-touch attribution (MTA) model**, quantifying channel contribution and informing marketing investment decisions across digital and offline campaigns.
- Partnered with Treasury and Credit Risk on **fund transfer pricing (FTP)** and equity allocation analysis, optimizing lending margins and cost-of-capital allocation for the home equity product.
- Managed the **CSAT/NPS** survey data pipeline for funded loan customers, enabling customer satisfaction tracking and VoC reporting for the home loans business.

Manager, Analytics & Data Management, Discover Financial Services, Chicago

Jul 2014 – Jul 2016

Led operational analytics and management reporting for the strategy and operations group of Discover Home Loans.

Project Manager, Analytics, Discover Financial Services, Chicago

Apr 2012 – Jul 2014

Delivered business analytics and management reporting for Discover Home Loans.

PREVIOUS EXPERIENCE

Senior Business Analyst, American Express, Phoenix

Apr 2010 – Apr 2012

Managed multi-million-dollar transformation and reporting projects for the Membership Rewards team.

Senior Consultant (Summer Associate), Deloitte Consulting LLP, Chicago

Jun 2008 – Aug 2008

Developed a \$40M business reengineering plan for a major healthcare insurer to transform its BI ecosystem.

Assistant System Engineer, Tata Consultancy Services, India

Feb 2007 – Jul 2007

Led a team developing technology solutions for American Express products.

Senior Software Engineer, UST Global, India

Dec 2003 – Oct 2006

Early career in enterprise software engineering for clients in insurance and financial services (American Express, FNIS).

EDUCATION

Chief Digital Officer Program, Executive Education | 2024

Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University

MBA, Finance, Marketing & Operations Management | 2009

Kelley School of Business, Indiana University

B.Tech., Electrical & Electronics Engineering | 2003

College of Engineering, University of Kerala, India

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Data Management Professional (CDMP) | AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner | MLOps Specialization (DeepLearning.AI)

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP, PUBLICATIONS & SPEAKING

- **Enterprise Identity Graph**: A practitioner's guide to building a Neo4j-based identity graph that serves marketing attribution, fraud detection, and privacy compliance from a single unified data layer. *Presented at Neo4j Graph Summit Chicago 2025.*
- **Controls Monitoring Operating Model**: A financial services framework connecting regulatory control obligations to active monitoring, exception tracking, incident triage, and remediation — the operating architecture that makes compliance measurable.
- **Digital Channel Containment**: Measuring where customers abandon digital channels for the phone, and why — a breakage and containment framework using NLP intent matching to locate CX friction and channel cost.
- **Enterprise Data Modernization**: A domain-centric architecture framework that resolves inconsistent metrics, unvalidated data, and unknown provenance through semantic layers, lineage, and observability — the governed data infrastructure AI agents now depend on.
- **Enterprise Data Management**: Data cataloging, profiling, quality monitoring, and stewardship — the multi-year foundation that underpins regulatory compliance, MDM, advanced analytics, and AI readiness.
- **Inside an Enterprise AI/ML Platform**: End-to-end MLOps in a regulated environment — cloud-native workbench, governed code promotion, feature store design, production monitoring tiers, and GenAI extension.
- **Responsible RAG for Document Matching**: A governed RAG pipeline with LLM extraction and human-in-the-loop (HITL) controls for resolving legacy document-to-account matching at scale.

Full portfolio and articles: www.rejozmathew.com/portfolio